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UPSC Intel · Daily Brief

MONDAY, 05 OCTOBER 2026

21 must-know stories, 19 Prelims facts, 19 editorials and 12 explainers, picked from 898 stories reported. Each item links to its source; notes quote the reports.

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MUST-KNOW

High-yield stories: make notes on these. Grouped by syllabus area.

Polity & Constitution

GS2 MAKE NOTES

Appointment of Chief Justices of High Courts as Judges of the Supreme Court of India

The Centre notified the appointment of three high court chief justices as judges of the Supreme Court. The appointments follow the recommendation made by the Supreme Court Collegium on September 28. The core issue involves filling vacancies in the apex court to manage its heavy judicial caseload. The newly appointed judges are Justice Sunita Agarwal, Justice Devendra Kumar Upadhyaya, and Justice Aparesh Kumar Singh. Justice Sunita Agarwal was serving as the Chief Justice of the Gujarat high court. Justice Devendra Kumar Upadhyaya was serving as the Chief Justice of the Delhi high court. Justice Aparesh Kumar Singh was serving as the Chief Justice of the Telangana high court. The appointments were made by the President of India under constitutional powers. These appointments will raise the effective strength of the Supreme Court to 37 judges once they take oath.

When: 2026-10-05 · **Where:** New Delhi · **Who:** Justice Sunita Agarwal, Justice Devendra Kumar Upadhyaya, Justice Aparesh Kumar Singh, President of India · **Prelims:** Justice Sunita Agarwal was the Chief Justice of the Gujarat high court.; Justice Devendra Kumar Upadhyaya was the Chief Justice of the Delhi high court.; Justice Aparesh Kumar Singh was the Chief Justice of the Telangana high court.

> ***Why it matters —*** *It helps maintain the judicial strength of the Supreme Court closer to its sanctioned capacity.; It ensures fair representation of various high courts in the highest judicial forum of the country.*

Static — Article 124(2) of the Constitution provides that every judge of the Supreme Court shall be appointed by the President by warrant under his hand and seal. The Supreme Court Collegium, comprising the Chief Justice of India and four senior-most judges, recommends appointments to the apex court. The sanctioned strength of the Supreme Court was increased to 38 judges, including the Chief Justice of India, following the Supreme Court Amendment Act, 2026.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution · Prelims angle: Judgment, Appointment

Hindustan Times: read the source · also reported by Bar & Bench

GS2 MAKE NOTES

Can States change ward boundaries during Census freeze? SC to hear plea

The matter has come to the Supreme Court as a legal challenge concerning the interpretation and enforcement of administrative boundary freezes under census laws. The Supreme Court is scheduled to hear a petition questioning whether State governments have the authority to alter ward boundaries while a statutory Census boundary freeze is in effect. Rule 8(iv) of the Census Rules 1990 requires State governments to “freeze the administrative boundaries of districts, tehsils, towns, etc.” from the date intimated by the Census Commissioner

When: 2026-10-05 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Supreme Court, Census Commissioner, State governments · **Prelims:** Rule 8(iv) of the Census Rules 1990 requires freezing of administrative boundaries.; Boundaries to be frozen include districts, tehsils, and towns.; The freeze is initiated from the date intimated by the Census Commissioner.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Highlights the legal friction between state-level administrative realignments and central statutory mandates during census operations.; Clarifies the strict applicability of Rule 8(iv) of the Census Rules 1990 regarding boundary freezes.*

Static — The Census of India is conducted under the provisions of the Census Act, 1948, which empowers the central government to notify and conduct a census. The Census Commissioner and Registrar General of India, operating under the Ministry of Home Affairs, directs and supervises the census operations across the nation. Rule 8(iv) of the Census Rules, 1990 explicitly prohibits changes to administrative boundaries like districts, tehsils, and towns once the Census Commissioner intimates the freeze date.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution, Governance & Policy · Prelims angle: Report/Index, Act/Bill/Rules

The Hindu: read the source

GS2 MAKE NOTES

Supreme Court Holds That Subsequent Larger Bench Ruling Cannot Serve as Ground for Review: Aadhaar Money Bill Case

The ruling came into focus through the Supreme Court's decision on review petitions linked to the Aadhaar Money Bill case. The Supreme Court held that a later ruling by a larger bench cannot serve as a valid ground to review a previous final judgment, specifically addressing the Aadhaar Money Bill review petitions.

When: 2026-10-05 · **Where:** New Delhi · **Who:** Supreme Court of India · **Prelims:** Review petitions must typically be considered by the same bench through circulation.

> ***Why it matters —*** *It reinforces the legal principle of finality in judicial verdicts.; It restricts the misuse of review petitions based on subsequent legal pronouncements.*

Static — The power of review of the Supreme Court of India is derived from Article 137 of the Constitution, which allows it to review any judgment or order pronounced by it. Under Order XLVII of the Supreme Court Rules, a review petition must be filed within 30 days of the judgment and is usually considered by the same bench through circulation without oral arguments. Grounds for review are extremely narrow: discovery of new and important matter or evidence, some mistake or error apparent on the face of the record, or any other sufficient reason.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution · Prelims angle: Judgment, Act/Bill/Rules

TaxCorp AI: read the source

GS2 MAKE NOTES

Supreme Court notice to ECI, Centre on plea challenging decisions taken by CEC-led poll panel

The Supreme Court issued a notice on a public interest litigation questioning the functioning of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar and the Special Intensive Revision process. The plea alleged that CEC Kumar took key decisions without the approval of the other two Election Commissioners. A bench led by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant along with Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana heard senior advocate Vikas Singh. Notices were issued to the Union of India, the Election Commission, CEC Gyanesh Kumar, Election Commissioners Dr Sukhbir Singh Sindhu and Dr Vivek Joshi, and other officials. The petitioner, Rakesh Kumar Singh from Patna, urged the court to determine if the CEC is exercising powers independently that belong to the Commission as a unit. The Supreme Court refused to pass an interim order to suspend the CEC, noting it would impact the working of the Election Commission. The court stated that if any decision taken by the Election Commission is found not to be in accordance with law, it will be annulled.

When: 2026-10-05 · **Where:** New Delhi · **Who:** Chief Justice Surya Kant, CEC Gyanesh Kumar, Rakesh Kumar Singh · **Prelims:** The PIL was filed by Patna resident Rakesh Kumar Singh.; The Supreme Court bench was headed by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant.; The other Election Commissioners named in the petition are Dr Sukhbir Singh Sindhu and Dr Vivek Joshi.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Highlights internal institutional governance and collective decision-making within the Election Commission of India.; Tests the judicial oversight of administrative and procedural decisions taken by constitutional functionaries.*

Static — The Election Commission of India is an autonomous constitutional body established under Article 324 of the Constitution to ensure free and fair elections in the country. Originally a single-member body, the Election Commission became a multi-member body with the appointment of additional Election Commissioners ahead of the 1989 general elections. Under the Chief Election Commissioner and other Election Commissioners (Appointment, Conditions of Service and Term of Office) Act, members are appointed by the President on the recommendation of a selection committee.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution · Prelims angle: Judgment

The Hindu: read the source · free copy on deccanherald.com · also reported by ETV Bharat, India Today, aninews.in, LawBeat, Bar & Bench, Hindustan Times, India Legal

GS2 MAKE NOTES

Investigating officer must collect evidence, not create it: Supreme Court upholds acquittal in murder case

The Supreme Court upheld the acquittal of a woman named Anchla, who was accused of murdering her stepmother and minor half-brother in 2011. The prosecution alleged the murders were committed over property bequeathed to the half-brother, relying on circumstantial evidence to build its case. The core issue was the reliability of key prosecution witnesses, specifically a taxi driver and a hotel employee who linked the accused to the crime scene. The Supreme Court observed that the investigating officer failed to explain what prompted the police to record the statements of these two witnesses. The Court noted that the taxi driver and hotel employee appeared to have been set up by the police to complete the chain of circumstantial evidence. The Bench ruled that an investigating officer's role is to collect evidence and not to create it. The Court pointed out that no blood was found inside the taxi despite claims of a bleeding injury, and no guest records were provided for the hotel stay. Finding the prosecution's case incomplete and untrustworthy, the Supreme Court dismissed the State government's appeal against the High Court acquittal.

When: October 1, 2026 · **Where:** Diur, Himachal Pradesh · **Who:** Anchla @ Chanchla, Justices Manoj Misra and Vijay Bishnoi · **Prelims:** The Supreme Court bench comprised Justices Manoj Misra and Vijay Bishnoi.; The murders took place in Diur, Himachal Pradesh, on September 7, 2011.; The sessions court had convicted the accused under Section 302 of the Indian Penal Code on November 7, 2012.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Reinforces the foundational principle of criminal jurisprudence that the prosecution must prove guilt beyond reasonable doubt without fabricated evidence.; Serves as a crucial reminder to police forces regarding the ethical and legal bounds of investigation and evidence collection.*

Static — Circumstantial evidence in criminal jurisprudence requires the prosecution to establish an unbroken chain of circumstances that points unequivocally to the guilt of the accused. The standard of proof in criminal trials is proof beyond reasonable doubt, and any missing link in circumstantial evidence benefits the accused. The role of the investigating officer under the Code of Criminal Procedure is fair and impartial investigation aimed at discovering the truth.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution · Prelims angle: Judgment

Bar & Bench: read the source

GS2 GS3 MAKE NOTES

SUPREME COURT UPHOLDS CUSTOMS AND GST ARREST POWERS; DIRECTS COMPLIANCE WITH STATUTORY AND CONSTITUTIONAL SAFEGUARDS

The ruling was delivered in response to petitions challenging the constitutional validity and arbitrary application of arrest powers by tax authorities. The Supreme Court has upheld the statutory powers of arrest under the Customs Act and GST laws while mandating strict adherence to constitutional and legal safeguards.

When: 2026-10-05 · **Where:** New Delhi · **Who:** Supreme Court of India · **Prelims:** The Supreme Court upheld arrest powers under the Customs Act and GST laws.; Authorities have been directed to comply with statutory and constitutional safeguards.; Officers must record written reasons before making an arrest under these laws.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Reconciles state revenue collection imperatives with individual fundamental liberties.; Provides clear judicial guardrails against potential overreach and harassment by tax enforcement officers.*

Static — The Customs Act, 1962 empowers designated officers to arrest individuals suspected of offenses related to smuggling or duty evasion under specific statutory conditions. The Central Goods and Services Tax (CGST) Act, 2017 contains provisions under Section 69 empowering the Commissioner to arrest persons for specified major tax evasion offenses. Article 21 of the Constitution guarantees that no person shall be deprived of life or personal liberty except according to procedure established by law.

Syllabus: GS2 / GS3: Polity & Constitution, Economy · Prelims angle: Judgment

AIMA Media: read the source

Governance & Policy

GS2 GS3 MAKE NOTES

Cabinet approves Rs 25,530 crore SARTHAK-PDS scheme to modernise public distribution system

The Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs approved the SARTHAK-PDS umbrella programme for food distribution. The Centre will spend Rs 25,530 crore as its share over the next five years until March 31, 2031. The programme integrates two existing initiatives: intra-state foodgrain movement assistance and the SMART PDS scheme. It aims to ensure assured financial support for intra-state transportation and enhance Fair Price Shop dealer margins. Revised norms for Central assistance to states and UTs were approved while retaining the existing funding pattern. The scheme seeks to build a unified, citizen-centric and technology-driven PDS architecture to minimise leakages. It proposes using advanced technologies like AI, machine learning, NLP, and blockchain to modernise PDS operations. The initiative supports food and nutritional security for around 81.35 crore beneficiaries covered under the NFSA.

When: 2026-10-05 · **Who:** Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs · **Prelims:** Total outlay for the SARTHAK-PDS scheme is Rs 25,530 crore.; The scheme will continue until March 31, 2031, covering the 16th Finance Commission cycle.; It integrates two existing schemes: intra-state movement assistance and SMART PDS.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Ensures assured financial support for intra-state transport and handling of foodgrains.; Enhances margins for Fair Price Shop dealers to improve last-mile delivery efficiency.*

Static — The Public Distribution System (PDS) in India operates under the joint responsibility of the Central and State Governments. The Central Government is responsible for procuring, storing, transporting, and bulk allocating foodgrains to state governments. State governments are responsible for identifying eligible beneficiaries, issuing ration cards, and distributing foodgrains through Fair Price Shops.

Syllabus: GS2 / GS3: Governance & Policy · Prelims angle: Scheme, Data/Stats

ddnews.gov.in: read the source

GS2 GS3 MAKE NOTES

National Household Travel Survey July, 2025 – June, 2026

The National Statistics Office released the findings of the first-ever National Household Travel Survey conducted between July 2025 and June 2026. The survey was carried out by the NSO under the Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation to generate data-driven insights into domestic travel. The survey defined a trip as any travel covering a distance of more than 1 km. The massive exercise covered 14,274 villages, 10,377 urban blocks, 4,92,023 households, and 20,34,371 persons across India. Students aged 15-29 years recorded the highest regular trip participation at 79.1 per cent in rural areas and 73.3 per cent in urban areas. Walking serves 37.0 per cent of students nationwide, buses carry 29.5 per cent, and bicycles account for 15.8 per cent. Over half of all workers aged 15 and above perform daily trips to workplaces, with a gender divide showing 61.9 per cent male workers commuting versus 41.9 per cent female workers. Two-wheelers are the predominant choice for 42.6 per cent of the workforce for commuting to fixed workplaces. Average monthly commuting expenditure for fixed workplaces stands at Rs 1,044 in urban areas and Rs 612 in rural areas.

When: July 2025 – June 2026 · **Where:** India · **Who:** National Statistics Office (NSO), Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (MoSPI) · **Prelims:** The survey was conducted from July 2025 to June 2026 by the National Statistics Office.; A trip was defined in the survey as travel covering a distance of more than 1 km.; The survey covered 4,92,023 households and 20,34,371 persons across India.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Provides critical baseline data on transport modal split for students and workers across India.; Highlights gender disparities in workforce commuting participation and financial costs incurred by households.*

Static — The National Statistical Office (NSO) is responsible for conducting large-scale sample surveys in India under the Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation. MoSPI was created as an independent ministry in 1999, combining the Department of Statistics and the Department of Programme Implementation. Household consumer expenditure and travel surveys help governments frame evidence-based policies for public transport infrastructure and regional planning.

Syllabus: GS2 / GS3: Governance & Policy, Economy · Prelims angle: Report/Index

PIB: read the source · free copy on msn.com · also reported by Business Standard, All India Radio (NewsOnAir)

GS2 MAKE NOTES

Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission emerges as one of world's largest digital health ecosystems with over 93.95 crore ABHA IDs: J.P. Nadda

Union Health Minister J.P. Nadda stated that the Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission (ABDM) has emerged as one of the world's largest digital health ecosystems. The statement was made while chairing the third meeting of the Mission Steering Group (MSG) to review the progress of the flagship initiative. The core issue discussed was focusing the next phase of the mission on maximizing adoption and utilization of digital health across the country. The mission has generated more than 93.95 crore Ayushman Bharat Health Account (ABHA) numbers and linked over 105 crore digital health records. It has registered 5.33 lakh health facilities and 9.85 lakh healthcare professionals on the national digital health registries. Nearly 24 crore Scan and Register tokens have been generated to facilitate faster outpatient department registration and consent-based health information sharing. The meeting reviewed integration with schemes like Ayushman Bharat PM-JAY, CGHS, ESIC, and Nikshay, alongside initiatives like Model Districts and Aarogya Setu 2.0. Future roadmap discussions included leveraging emerging technologies like artificial intelligence and strengthening institutional capacities to support Viksit Bharat by 2047.

When: 2026-10-05 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Jagat Prakash Nadda, Union Health Minister · **Prelims:** Over 93.95 crore ABHA IDs have been generated under ABDM.; More than 105 crore digital health records have been linked.; 5.33 lakh health facilities and 9.85 lakh healthcare professionals are registered on the national digital health registries.

> ***Why it matters —*** *It establishes one of the world's largest digital public infrastructures for healthcare, enabling nationwide interoperability.; Consent-based access to health records empowers citizens and ensures better continuity of care.*

Static — The Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission (ABDM) aims to develop the necessary support to integrate India's digital health infrastructure cohesively. The National Health Authority (NHA) is the apex body responsible for implementing the Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission across India. ABDM creates a seamless online platform through the provision of a unique Ayushman Bharat Health Account (ABHA) identifier for every citizen.

Syllabus: GS2: Governance & Policy, Health · Prelims angle: Scheme, Data/Stats

ddnews.gov.in: read the source

International Relations

GS2 MAKE NOTES

India-Switzerland Bilateral Talks: PM Modi & President Parmelin ink 6 pacts on trade, mobility, tech & nuclear energy

India and Switzerland inked five agreements following bilateral talks between Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Swiss President Guy Parmelin in New Delhi. The signed pacts cover Migration and Mobility Partnership, Exchange of Young Professionals, and cooperation in transportation technologies. Additional agreements include a Letter of Intent between the Department of Science and Technology and the Swiss National Science Foundation. Prime Minister Modi highlighted the implementation of the historic Trade and Economic Partnership Agreement with EFTA countries last October. India aims to attract 100 billion US dollars in investment and create ten lakh direct jobs over 15 years through the EFTA framework. Both leaders identified new possibilities for cooperation in military exchanges, defence production, and nuclear energy. Swiss President Guy Parmelin arrived in New Delhi on a three-day state visit accompanied by senior officials and business leaders.

When: 2026-10-05 · **Where:** New Delhi · **Who:** Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Swiss President Guy Parmelin · **Prelims:** Swiss President Guy Parmelin arrived in New Delhi on a three-day state visit.; The two nations signed agreements including Migration and Mobility Partnership and Exchange of Young Professionals.; India implemented the TEPA with EFTA countries last October.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Deepens bilateral economic and strategic engagement between India and a key European economy.; Advances the implementation goals of the India-EFTA TEPA to attract substantial foreign investments and generate employment.*

Static — The European Free Trade Association (EFTA) is a regional trade organisation and free trade area consisting of four European states: Iceland, Liechtenstein, Norway, and Switzerland. India and EFTA signed a Trade and Economic Partnership Agreement (TEPA) to boost economic ties, investments, and job creation between the regions. Bilateral diplomatic relations between India and Switzerland were formalized through a Treaty of Friendship signed in August 1948 shortly after India independence.

Syllabus: GS2: International Relations, Infrastructure & Energy · Prelims angle: Agreement/MoU

newsonair.gov.in: read the source · also reported by BusinessLine, Hindustan Times, psuindia.com, Pragativadi, Republic World, DD India, Times of India, ANI News

GS2 GS3 MAKE NOTES

India-EU trade deal to boost exports, jobs in labour-intensive sectors: Sitharaman

Union Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman stated that the India-EU trade agreement will help create more jobs and boost exports in labour-intensive sectors. Targeted sectors include textiles, footwear, toys, processed goods, and components, many of which belong to micro and small enterprises. Sitharaman noted that textiles involve a large workforce, particularly women, and greater European market access will directly benefit employment generation. India has opened 92.5 per cent of its tariff lines, covering roughly 97 per cent of tariff value under the agreement. The European Union has opened about 99 per cent in value terms and around 97 per cent of its tariff lines. Regarding the India-US trade agreement, Sitharaman noted negotiations have reached a plateau where further concessions are difficult. External Affairs Minister S. Jaishankar, speaking at the Munich Leaders Meeting, highlighted India-Europe cooperation in tech, semiconductors, AI, defence, and space. Jaishankar emphasized that a Free Trade Agreement (FTA) with the EU acts as a real game changer in strengthening mutual confidence.

When: 2026-10-05 · **Where:** Munich, Germany · **Who:** Nirmala Sitharaman, S. Jaishankar · **Prelims:** India opened 92.5 per cent of its tariff lines covering around 97 per cent of tariff value under the EU agreement.; The European Union opened about 99 per cent in value terms and around 97 per cent of its tariff lines.; Sitharaman and Jaishankar made their remarks at the Munich Leaders Meeting.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Highlights the strategic and economic importance of the India-EU trade deal for job creation in India's MSME sector.; Demonstrates India's proactive approach to opening tariff lines while securing reciprocal market access.*

Static — Free Trade Agreements (FTAs) are international treaties that reduce or eliminate tariff and non-tariff barriers on trade in goods and services between participating countries. Tariff lines refer to the specific detailed list of items in a country's customs tariff schedule, representing individual products traded internationally. Micro, Small, and Medium Enterprises (MSMEs) form the backbone of India's manufacturing sector and are major contributors to employment and exports.

Syllabus: GS2 / GS3: International Relations, Economy · Prelims angle: Agreement/MoU, Data/Stats

BusinessLine: read the source · free copy on zeebiz.com

GS2 MAKE NOTES

Visit of H.E. Emmanuel Macron, President of French Republic & First Lady Madame Brigitte Macron to Mumbai & Delhi, India for attending opening ceremony of AI Impact Summit 2026 (February 16-19, 2026)

The French President visited India to attend the opening ceremony of the AI Impact Summit 2026 held from February 16-19, 2026. French President Emmanuel Macron and First Lady Madame Brigitte Macron visited Mumbai and Delhi in India to attend the AI Impact Summit 2026.

When: February 16-19, 2026 · **Where:** Mumbai and Delhi, India · **Who:** H.E. Emmanuel Macron and Madame Brigitte Macron · **Prelims:** Visitor: H.E. Emmanuel Macron, President of French Republic; Accompanied by: First Lady Madame Brigitte Macron; Locations visited: Mumbai and Delhi, India

> ***Why it matters —*** *Highlights growing bilateral cooperation between India and France in emerging technologies like Artificial Intelligence.; Strengthens diplomatic ties through high-level state visits between the two nations.*

Static — India-France bilateral relations span strategic partnership, defence cooperation, civil nuclear energy, and space collaboration. Bilateral mechanisms include regular high-level summits, foreign office consultations, and joint working groups across key sectors.

Syllabus: GS2: International Relations, Science & Technology

Ministry of External Affairs: read the source

Economy

GS2 GS3 MAKE NOTES

New bilateral investment treaty framework to get Cabinet nod: Sitharaman

Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman announced that a new template for bilateral investment treaties is ready and expected to receive Cabinet approval soon. The new template, prepared over the last one-and-a-half years, aims to address shortcomings in the 2016 model and provide sharper protection to investors. India has already concluded agreements incorporating elements of the new approach with Saudi Arabia, the UAE, Oman, and some Central Asian countries. Negotiations are currently underway with several countries including Canada and Russia regarding bilateral investment protection agreements. India expects to conclude agreements with at least three more countries by December, with Canada talks possibly wrapping up by early next year. The 2016 model required foreign investors to exhaust domestic remedies for five years before initiating treaty-based arbitration against India. Sitharaman noted that India-US trade agreement negotiations are ongoing, and acknowledged trade imbalances with both the US and China.

When: 2026-10-05 · **Where:** New Delhi / Munich · **Who:** Nirmala Sitharaman · **Prelims:** The new template for bilateral investment treaties was prepared over the last one-and-a-half years.; India has concluded investment agreements with Saudi Arabia, the UAE, Oman, and some Central Asian countries.; The 2016 model BIT required foreign investors to wait for five years before initiating treaty-based arbitration against India.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Enhances confidence for both foreign investors in India and domestic companies investing abroad.; Addresses long-standing criticisms regarding the mandatory five-year wait for domestic remedies before arbitration.*

Static — A bilateral investment treaty (BIT) is an agreement between two nations establishing the terms and conditions for private investments made by nationals and companies of one state in another state. India adopted a new Model BIT in 2016, which significantly departed from older international practices by prioritising state regulatory space and requiring exhaustion of local remedies. The 2016 Indian Model BIT mandated that foreign investors exhaust local judicial remedies for a period of five years before initiating international arbitration.

Syllabus: GS2 / GS3: Economy, International Relations, Governance & Policy · Prelims angle: Agreement/MoU

Business Standard: read the source · *free copy on deccanchronicle.com*

GS3 MAKE NOTES

RBI’s Monetary Policy Committee meeting begins in Mumbai

The Reserve Bank of India’s Monetary Policy Committee began its three-day meeting in Mumbai. The policy review is taking place amid renewed tensions in West Asia and elevated crude oil prices. The Committee is evaluating ongoing concerns over food inflation and the broader domestic economic conditions. Members will assess the overall inflation outlook before announcing the final policy decision. The last repo rate hike occurred in February 2023 when the rate was raised by 25 basis points to 6.50 per cent. The RBI kept rates unchanged through 2023-24 before initiating a rate-cut cycle in 2025. The policy repo rate currently stands at 5.25 per cent.

When: 2026-10-05 · **Where:** Mumbai · **Who:** Reserve Bank of India Monetary Policy Committee · **Prelims:** The MPC meeting is being held in Mumbai.; The meeting duration is three days.; The last repo rate hike was in February 2023 by 25 basis points to 6.50 per cent.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Helps aspirants understand the institutional mechanism behind India's monetary policy formulation.; Crucial for analyzing macroeconomic indicators like repo rates, inflation targets, and growth dynamics.*

Static — The Monetary Policy Committee (MPC) is a statutory and institutionalized framework under the Reserve Bank of India Act, 1934, for fixing the benchmark policy interest rate. The MPC consists of six members: the RBI Governor as chairperson, four external members appointed by the central government, and one official nominated by the RBI. The primary mandate of the MPC is to maintain price stability while keeping in mind the objective of economic growth.

Syllabus: GS3: Economy

newsonair.gov.in: read the source · also reported by indiatoday.in, Economic Times, Business Standard, News18, Bhaskar English, Goodreturns

GS3 MAKE NOTES

Samudra Manthan: India’s Rs 84,084-crore mission to unlock offshore energy and strengthen energy security

India launched Samudra Manthan, the National Offshore Exploration Scheme, approved on 31 July 2026, with a Phase-I financial outlay of Rs. 84,084 crore up to FY 2030-31. The mission addresses heavy import dependence, high crude oil import bills of USD 144 billion, and natural production declines of 6 to 7 percent in mature fields. The core issue tackles high financial risks and capital-intensive nature of deepwater drilling, where a single well costs between USD 125 million and USD 150 million. Component one allocates Rs. 28,534 crore for extensive 2D and 3D seismic surveys, deploying AI and reprocessing older datasets via the National Data Repository. Component two allocates Rs. 43,200 crore to support drilling 60 deepwater and ultra-deepwater exploration wells, providing financial assistance of up to 50 percent or Rs. 675 crore per well. Component three earmarks Rs. 10,000 crore for shared offshore infrastructure in selected basins like Mahanadi and Kutch to make stranded discoveries commercially viable. Component four establishes an Oil and Gas Manufacturing and Services Zone with Rs. 2,000 crore to strengthen domestic industrial capabilities and reduce imported equipment dependence.

When: 31 July 2026 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Ministry / Government of India · **Prelims:** Phase-I financial outlay of Samudra Manthan is Rs. 84,084 crore up to FY 2030-31.; Drilling of the first appraisal well in the Mahanadi Offshore Basin commenced on 25 July 2026.; India's annual crude oil import bill stands at nearly USD 144 billion or Rs. 13 lakh crore.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Aims to add over 600 Million Metric Tonnes of Oil Equivalent to hydrocarbon reserves and raise domestic production to nearly 80 MMTOE annually.; Seeks to reduce India's annual crude oil import bill by nearly Rs. 1 lakh crore and generate significant foreign exchange savings.*

Static — India's upstream oil and gas sector was historically governed by a nomination regime favoring public sector undertakings like ONGC and Oil India before major reforms. The Hydrocarbon Exploration and Licensing Policy (HELP), introduced in 2016, replaced Production Sharing Contracts with Revenue Sharing Contracts to simplify fiscal terms. The Open Acreage Licensing Policy (OALP) allows companies to carve out exploration blocks of their choice throughout the year based on data from the National Data Repository.

Syllabus: GS3: Economy, Infrastructure & Energy, Governance & Policy · Prelims angle: Scheme, Data/Stats

ddnews.gov.in: read the source

Infrastructure & Energy

GS3 MAKE NOTES

India's Union Cabinet approves 50 GWh of BESS under the GEC-III scheme

The Union Cabinet granted its formal approval for the initiative. The Union Cabinet has approved 50 GWh of Battery Energy Storage Systems (BESS) under the Green Energy Corridor-III (GEC-III) scheme.

When: 2026-10-05 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Union Cabinet · **Prelims:** Approved capacity: 50 GWh; Scheme name: Green Energy Corridor-III (GEC-III); Approving body: Union Cabinet

> ***Why it matters —*** *Crucial for balancing grid load amid rising share of intermittent renewable energy.; Helps India meet its ambitious non-fossil energy targets for 2030.*

Static — Green Energy Corridor (GEC) is a scheme aimed at synchronizing electricity produced from renewable sources with conventional power stations. Battery Energy Storage Systems (BESS) enable power to be stored and released when required, stabilizing intermittent renewable energy. The Union Cabinet of India is the supreme executive body of the Union responsible for advising the President.

Syllabus: GS3: Infrastructure & Energy, Governance & Policy · Prelims angle: Scheme

Solarbytes: read the source · also reported by The Hindu

Environment & Ecology

GS3 MAKE NOTES

India and Japan Launch Operational Manual for the Joint Crediting Mechanism

India and Japan launched the Operational Manual for the Joint Crediting Mechanism on 30th September, 2026, in New Delhi. The manual was jointly launched by Ambassador of Japan to India H.E. Mr. Keiichi Ono and MoEFCC Secretary Shri Tanmay Kumar. The JCM is a bilateral mechanism between India and Japan to promote low-carbon technology deployment, mobilize climate finance, and support emission reductions. The mechanism operates under Article 6.2 of the Paris Agreement, following a Memorandum of Cooperation signed on 7th August 2025. The Rule of Implementation for the mechanism was adopted earlier on 8th June 2026. The launch moves the JCM from institutional preparation to actual implementation with a transparent procedural framework. The manual covers the complete project cycle from Project Idea Note submission to credit issuance and authorization.

When: 30th September, 2026 · **Where:** New Delhi · **Who:** Ambassador of Japan to India H.E. Mr. Keiichi Ono and MoEFCC Secretary Shri Tanmay Kumar · **Prelims:** The JCM Operational Manual was launched on 30th September, 2026.; The Memorandum of Cooperation (MoC) for the JCM was signed on 7th August 2025.; The Rule of Implementation (RoI) was adopted on 8th June 2026.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Operationalizes bilateral climate cooperation and facilitates technology transfer between India and Japan.; Encourages high-integrity emission reductions and supports sustainable development in India.*

Static — Article 6.2 of the Paris Agreement allows countries to use Internationally Transferred Mitigation Outcomes (ITMOs) to achieve their Nationally Determined Contributions. Bilateral carbon crediting mechanisms like the JCM allow partner countries to transfer emission reduction credits while avoiding double counting. Japan has established similar bilateral JCM frameworks with multiple developing countries to promote decarbonization technologies globally.

Syllabus: GS3: Environment & Ecology, International Relations, Governance & Policy

PIB: read the source · free copy on civilsdaily.com

GS2 GS3 MAKE NOTES

Supreme Court refuses to stay Calcutta HC order in Great Nicobar Island Project; terms 'preservation of culture' a fundamental right

The Supreme Court refused to block former IAS officer Meena Gupta's PIL challenging statutory approvals for the Rs. 920-billion Great Nicobar Island project. The Centre and the Andaman and Nicobar administration challenged a Calcutta High Court circuit bench order that had refused to dismiss Gupta's petition on maintainability. The core legal battle centers on whether the PIL survives, involving compliance with forest laws and the rights of vulnerable indigenous tribes. The bench comprised Chief Justice of India Surya Kant, Justice Joymalya Bagchi, and Justice V Mohana, who asked the high court to hear the matter expeditiously. Senior advocate S Muralidhar represented Gupta, arguing that tribal councils complained they were not heard before project approvals were granted. Attorney General R Venkataramani and ASG Aishwarya Bhati defended the project, citing its utmost strategic and national importance near the Malacca Strait. The Supreme Court observed that the preservation of culture is a constitutionally protected fundamental right that must receive protection. The project involves an international container transhipment terminal, greenfield airport, power complex, and urban township requiring diversion of about 130.75 sq km of forest land.

When: 2026-10-05 · **Where:** Great Nicobar Island · **Who:** Supreme Court bench, Meena Gupta, S Muralidhar, R Venkataramani · **Prelims:** The cost of the Great Nicobar Island project is estimated at Rs. 920 billion.; The project requires the diversion of about 130.75 sq km of forest land.; The Shompen are classified as a Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Group.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Highlights the judicial balancing act between national security and strategic maritime interests versus environmental protection and tribal rights.; Affirms that the preservation of culture is a constitutionally protected fundamental right under Indian jurisprudence.*

Static — The Great Nicobar Island Project is a massive infrastructure and strategic initiative planned at the southern tip of the Andaman and Nicobar Islands near the Malacca Strait. The project features an international container transhipment terminal, a greenfield international airport, a gas and solar-based power plant, and a large township. The Shompen and Nicobarese are indigenous inhabitants of the islands, with the Shompen classified as a Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Group (PVTG) living in isolation.

Syllabus: GS2 / GS3: Environment & Ecology, Polity & Constitution, History, Art & Culture, Geography · Prelims angle: Judgment, Act/Bill/Rules, Place in news

The Hindu: read the source · free copy on outlookindia.com · also reported by Hindustan Times

GS3 MAKE NOTES

CAQM intensifies field-level monitoring with deployment of Flying Squads to prevent paddy stubble burning incidents in Punjab and Haryana

The Commission for Air Quality Management (CAQM) deployed flying squads across 34 districts in Punjab and Haryana to prevent paddy stubble burning. The core objective is to assess ground-level situations, coordinate with enforcement agencies, and take prompt preventive actions against stubble burning. The deployment covers 18 districts in Punjab and 16 districts in Haryana in structured, successive phases for sustained monitoring. Covered districts in Punjab include Sangrur, Tarn Taran, Firozpur, Muktsar, Bathinda, Amritsar, Moga, Mansa, Fazilka, Patiala, and Ludhiana. Covered districts in Haryana include Jind, Fatehabad, Hisar, Kaithal, Sonipat, Rohtak, Sirsa, Karnal, Palwal, Jhajjar, and Kurukshetra. Flying squads will coordinate closely with farmers, Parali Protection Force, district authorities, state pollution control boards, and the CAQM Cell. The teams are required to report the ground situation and preventive steps taken to the CAQM Cell on a daily basis.

When: October 1, 2026 to November 30, 2026 · **Where:** Punjab and Haryana · **Who:** Commission for Air Quality Management (CAQM), Central Pollution Control Board (CPCB) · **Prelims:** Flying squads are deployed in 34 districts across Haryana and Punjab.; 18 districts in Punjab and 16 districts in Haryana are covered under this initiative.; Teams report ground situations and preventive steps to the CAQM Cell on a daily basis.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Crucial for mitigating severe winter air pollution crises in Delhi-NCR caused by stubble burning.; Enforces ground-level accountability by bridging central directives with state-level administrative implementation.*

Static — The Commission for Air Quality Management (CAQM) is a statutory body established under the Commission for Air Quality Management in National Capital Region and Adjoining Areas Act, 2021. It aims to better coordinate, research, identify, and resolve problems related to air quality in the National Capital Region and adjoining areas. The Commission replaced the Supreme Court-mandated Environment Pollution (Prevention and Control) Authority (EPCA) which had operated for years.

Syllabus: GS3: Environment & Ecology, Agriculture & Allied, Governance & Policy

PIB: read the source · free copy on ptinews.com

Science & Technology

GS3 MAKE NOTES

TDB-DST signs agreement with BigEndian Semiconductors for Rs. 130 crore RDI support to develop indigenous AI Vision SoC

The Technology Development Board under the Department of Science and Technology signed an agreement with Bengaluru-based BigEndian Semiconductors on 5 October 2026. The agreement provides Rs. 130 crore under the Research Development and Innovation Fund for Project VeerAI to develop an indigenous AI Vision SoC. The core issue is reducing dependence on external semiconductor supply chains by building secure, sovereign technology platforms for critical applications. Project VeerAI has a total project cost of Rs. 260 crore, with TDB financial support structured as Optional Convertible Debt. The project aims to advance technology maturity from Technology Readiness Level 5 to Technology Readiness Level 9. The camera-focused AI Vision System-on-Chip is initially designed for secure CCTV-based surveillance systems. Beyond surveillance, the platform is planned for deployment across defence, automotive, industrial, and medical sectors. The initiative leverages India's growing VLSI design talent to translate domestic design capabilities into scalable product platforms.

When: 5 October 2026 · **Where:** Bengaluru, Karnataka · **Who:** Technology Development Board, Department of Science & Technology, BigEndian Semiconductors · **Prelims:** TDB provided Rs. 130 crore financial support under the RDI Fund for Project VeerAI.; The total project cost for Project VeerAI is Rs. 260 crore.; Financial support is structured through Optional Convertible Debt.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Reduces India's reliance on external semiconductor and technology supply chains for critical infrastructure.; Advances indigenous design capabilities in strategic sectors like defence, automotive, and surveillance.*

Static — The Technology Development Board was established under the Technology Development Board Act, 1995, and functions under the Department of Science and Technology. Optional Convertible Debt is a financing instrument that can be converted into equity under specified conditions during project implementation. A System-on-Chip integrates multiple electronic components, such as processors, memory, and input-output interfaces, on a single semiconductor chip.

Syllabus: GS3: Science & Technology · Prelims angle: Agreement/MoU, Data/Stats

PIB: read the source · free copy on gktoday.in

GS3 MAKE NOTES

Optogenetics: How the 2026 Nobel Prize Revolutionised Neuroscience

The 2026 Nobel Prize in Physiology or Medicine was awarded to Karl Deisseroth, Peter Hegemann, and Georg Nagel. They won the prestigious prize for their discoveries concerning light-gated ion channels and optogenetics. Their pioneering work enabled researchers to control the activity of specific cells using light. Peter Hegemann and Georg Nagel discovered channelrhodopsin, a light-sensitive protein found in specific cells. Karl Deisseroth introduced the gene for channelrhodopsin into nerve cells from rats and triggered nerve signals using blue light. Deisseroth later demonstrated that this light-controlled switch could control nerve cells in the brains of living mice. The laureates will share a prize sum amounting to 12 million Swedish crowns, which equals about $1.2 million. The award was announced by the Nobel Assembly of Sweden's Karolinska Institute medical university.

When: 2026-10-05 · **Where:** Sweden · **Who:** Karl Deisseroth, Peter Hegemann, Georg Nagel, Nobel Assembly of Karolinska Institute · **Prelims:** Winners of the 2026 Nobel medicine prize: Karl Deisseroth, Peter Hegemann, and Georg Nagel.; Prize amount: 12 million Swedish crowns ($1.2 million).; Selecting institution: Nobel Assembly of Sweden's Karolinska Institute medical university.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Optogenetics has transformed neuroscience by allowing precise control of individual nerve cells in living brains.; The method helps laboratories around the world reveal the complex mysteries of how the brain and nervous system function.*

Static — The Nobel Prize in Physiology or Medicine is awarded annually by the Nobel Assembly at Karolinska Institutet in Stockholm, Sweden. The prize was established by the will of Alfred Nobel, a Swedish chemist, engineer, and industrialist, signed in 1895. The Nobel Assembly for the prize consists of 50 voting members who are professors in medical subjects at the Karolinska Institute.

Syllabus: GS3: Science & Technology, Health · Prelims angle: Award

Hindustan Times: read the source · also reported by Times of India

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PRELIMS FACTS

Concrete developments worth a quick read: exercises, pacts, Acts, approvals, schemes, species, verdicts.

DEFENCE EXERCISE SCHEME QUICK READ

INDIA-UAE JOINT MILITARY EXERCISE MOUNTAIN GUARDIAN 2026 COMMENCES IN UTTARAKHAND

The India-UAE joint military exercise MOUNTAIN GUARDIAN 2026 commenced on October 5 at the Foreign Training Node in Chaubatia, Uttarakhand. The exercise is scheduled to continue until October 18, 2026, aiming to enhance interoperability and mutual understanding between the Indian and UAE armies. The core focus of the joint training programme is on mountain warfare, tactical coordination, and operating in challenging mountainous terrain.

PIB: source

ENVIRONMENT & ECOLOGY | SPECIES | PLACE IN NEWS | QUICK READ

Indian-born Cheetah gives birth to 5 Healthy Cubs at Kuno National Park; India's Cheetah Population reaches 60

Five cheetah cubs were born at Kuno National Park in Madhya Pradesh on 5 October 2026 to KJP21, an Indian-born female cheetah. This birth raised India's total cheetah population to 60, which includes 41 cheetahs born on Indian soil. The father of the new litter is a male cheetah from Botswana, introducing the Botswanan genetic lineage into India.

PIB: source

POLITY & CONSTITUTION | JUDGMENT | QUICK READ

Election Commission "Fact-Checks" Rahul Gandhi's Form 6 Allegations

The Election Commission issued a fact-check rejecting Rahul Gandhi's claim that Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar illegally altered Form 6. Rahul Gandhi alleged on X that the CEC unilaterally changed Form 6, citing a recent Supreme Court observation. The core issue involves the legality of an added declaration during the Special Intensive Revision of electoral rolls in Bihar.

Times of India: source

ECONOMY | ACT/BILL/RULES | QUICK READ

Directions under Section 35A read with Section 56 of the Banking Regulation Act, 1949 – Ramgarhia Co-operative Bank Limited, New Delhi

The RBI determined that it is necessary in the public interest to further extend the period of operation of the existing directive. The Reserve Bank of India extended the regulatory directions imposed on Ramgarhia Co-operative Bank Limited, New Delhi, beyond October 08, 2026.

RBI: source

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS | AGREEMENT/MOU | QUICK READ

India, Sri Lanka cooperatives sign MoU on supply of essential food commodities

The signing of the cooperative MoU between India and Sri Lanka for essential food commodities. India and Sri Lanka cooperatives signed an MoU to ensure the smooth supply and distribution of essential food commodities.

Newswire: source

SOCIAL JUSTICE & WELFARE | JUDGMENT | QUICK READ

Allahabad High Court Launches Hindi E-Booklet on Supreme Court's Landmark Child Sexual Exploitation Material Judgment

The release of the e-booklet puts the Supreme Court's landmark ruling into focus for Hindi-speaking legal practitioners and citizens. The Allahabad High Court has released a Hindi e-booklet explaining a significant Supreme Court ruling concerning child sexual exploitation material.

lawtrend.in: source

ENVIRONMENT & ECOLOGY | PLACE IN NEWS | QUICK READ

Maharashtra Forest Dept launches state-level Wildlife Week celebrations at Lonar Lake

The Maharashtra Forest Department inaugurated the state-level Wildlife Week celebrations at Lonar Lake in Buldhana district. The celebrations kicked off with an awareness rally where hundreds of students marched through Lonar city shouting slogans to save forests and wildlife. Retired Principal Chief Conservator of Forests Yogita Vishwas spoke about forest service careers and building a connection with nature.

newsonair.gov.in: source

DEFENCE | QUICK READ

First Fleet Support Ship (FSS-1)

Defence Minister Rajnath Singh launched Fleet Support Ship-1, named Surya, and laid the keel for Fleet Support Ship-5 at Hindustan Shipyard Limited. The launch took place at Visakhapatnam, marking a major step in enhancing the indigenous shipbuilding capabilities of the Indian Navy. Fleet Support Ship-1 is a 43,500-tonne vessel built with 82% Indian content and entered the Bay of Bengal 18 months after steel cutting.

The Hindu: source

ENVIRONMENT & ECOLOGY | QUICK READ

Maharashtra govt orders 10% water cut from October 16 across state amid El Niño concerns

The Maharashtra government has ordered a minimum 10 percent water cut across urban local bodies starting from October 16. The decision is driven by concerns over limited water reserves and reduced rainfall linked to El Niño. The Water Resources Department has planned dam-wise and usage-wise water allocation up to August 31, 2027.

Hindustan Times: source

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS QUICK READ

Nepal Home Minister Gurung to visit India for BIMSTEC meeting

Nepal Home Minister Sudan Gurung is scheduled to visit India on October 12 for his first foreign trip since assuming office. He will participate in the inaugural meeting of home ministers of BIMSTEC in New Delhi on October 13. The regional grouping comprises seven member states: Bangladesh, Bhutan, India, Myanmar, Nepal, Sri Lanka, and Thailand.

BusinessLine: source

POLITY & CONSTITUTION QUICK READ

Legislative privilege versus free speech: SC may not hear on merits after TN Assembly says resolution was withdrawn

The Supreme Court indicated that its seven-judge Constitution Bench may not decide on merits whether legislative privileges override free speech. This shift happened after the Tamil Nadu Assembly informed the court that the disputed 2003 resolution had actually been withdrawn in 2004. The original case involved journalist N Ravi and others who challenged an arrest order issued in 2003 by then Speaker K Kalimuthu for breach of privilege.

The Hindu: source

POLITY & CONSTITUTION JUDGMENT ACT/BILL/RULES QUICK READ

Modi Govt’s Election Law Remains In Force, As Supreme Court’s Unwritten Rules Delay A Verdict For 2 Years

The case marks two years of pendency without a final judicial resolution from the Supreme Court. The Modi government election law remains in force as the Supreme Court has delayed its verdict for two years due to institutional practices.

article-14.com: source

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS QUICK READ

India, Canada to begin fifth CEPA round today; eye deeper ties in energy, critical minerals: Trade Minister Maninder Sidhu

India and Canada are initiating the fifth round of negotiations for a Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement in Ottawa. Canadian International Trade Minister Maninder Sidhu announced the talks, aiming to expand bilateral economic ties. The talks follow discussions between Sidhu and Union Commerce Minister Piyush Goyal in Mumbai following the G20 Trade Ministers Meeting.

BusinessLine: source

POLITY & CONSTITUTION QUICK READ

NHRC, India to hold Open Hearing and Camp Sitting at Patna to hear cases of alleged human rights violations in Bihar on 7th-8th October 2026

The National Human Rights Commission is holding a two-day Open Hearing and Camp Sitting at Gyan Bhawan in Patna on October 7 and 8, 2026. The proceedings aim to hear cases of alleged human rights violations in Bihar by bringing complainants and state authorities face-to-face. On the first day, October 7, the Full Commission led by Chairperson Justice V. Ramasubramanian will hear cases directly with state officers.

PIB: source

DEFENCE QUICK READ

Rajnath Singh to lay foundation stone for Shakti engine facility at HAL in Odisha's Sunabeda

Defence Minister Rajnath Singh will lay the foundation stone for new facilities linked to the Shakti engine at HAL in Odisha's Koraput district on October 6. The visit aims to boost India's domestic military engine manufacturing capabilities and reduce import dependence in the defence sector. The Shakti engine programme is a joint Indo-French initiative between HAL and Safran Helicopter Engines to develop the Safran Ardiden 1H1 turboshaft engine.

Economic Times: source

EDUCATION REPORT/INDEX QUICK READ

Teachers navigating transformations driven by AI, climate change, migration: UNESCO report

A UNESCO report released on World Teachers' Day highlights that the teaching profession faces immense pressures from digital technologies, climate change, inclusion, and migration. The world requires an additional 50 million teachers by 2030 to guarantee universal access to pre-primary, primary, and secondary education under Sustainable Development Goal 4. Persistent shortages, rising attrition, and declining attractiveness make teacher recruitment and retention increasingly difficult globally.

theprint.in: source

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS QUICK READ

India’s 18th BRICS Summit focuses on trade, technology and Global South cooperation

The 18th BRICS Summit was converged in New Delhi, India, from September 12-13, marking the 20th anniversary of the cooperation mechanism. President Xi Jinping called for Greater BRICS economic cooperation to transform the bloc into a practical platform for Global South development. The core issue centers on whether BRICS is a geopolitical bloc countering Western hegemony or a genuine economic bloc fostering intra-group cooperation.

msn.com: source

INFRASTRUCTURE & ENERGY | AGREEMENT/MOU | QUICK READ

Centre, West Bengal sign MoU for four new airports to boost air connectivity

West Bengal is set to sign tripartite MoUs with the Centre for the construction of four new airports to boost regional air connectivity. The agreements are being executed under the Centre's regional connectivity scheme, known as the UDAN scheme. The signing ceremony takes place in Kolkata in the presence of Union Civil Aviation Minister K Ram Mohan Naidu and Chief Minister Suvendu Adhikari.

newsonair.gov.in: source

HISTORY, ART & CULTURE | AGREEMENT/MOU | QUICK READ

Nalanda University and CSIR-TKDL Sign MoU for IPR

Nalanda University and the CSIR-Traditional Knowledge Digital Library Unit signed an MoU to promote cooperation in traditional knowledge and intellectual property rights. The collaboration aims to bring together institutional expertise for research, documentation, and capacity building related to cultural heritage and traditional cultural expressions. The partnership emphasizes traditional cultural expressions of Bihar, including ecological knowledge, folklore, music, and other community-based knowledge systems.

drishtiias.com: source

EDITORIAL WATCH

What the opinion pages argued: two or three lines each.

GS2 UPSC Editorial Analysis: India in the Global Gender Gap Index

The World Economic Forum publishes the annual Global Gender Gap Index evaluating gender parity across four key dimensions. India ranks 131st out of 145 countries with an overall parity score of 64.5%, remaining below the global average of 69.2%. Regional peers like Bangladesh, Nepal, Bhutan, and Sri Lanka hold higher relative ranks on the index than India. India performs strongly in Educational Attainment at 96% and Health and Survival at 96%.

Insights on India

GS2 The ECI’s constitutional mandate is under strain

The Election Commission of India faces allegations of mass voter deletion through a Special Intensive Revision that critics argue lacks a clear legal basis. Draft Article 289 originally proposed decentralised election machinery, but Dr B.R. Ambedkar centralised it to prevent provincial governments from partisan voter deletions. Section 21(3) of the Representation of the People Act, 1950 permits special revisions only for specific constituencies, making a State-wide special revision contestable.

The Hindu

GS3 Climate index rings alarm bells

A new India Climate Extremes Index combined seven separate hazards, including daytime heat, humid heat, heatwave severity, and drought, into a single metric. Over five decades, the index reveals that India has warmed significantly and experienced expanding zones of heat and drought extremes. South India is drying up the fastest, with Odisha, Andhra Pradesh, and Tamil Nadu consistently recording drought conditions. More than 40% of the region along the eastern coast experienced droughts in recent years.

Deccan Herald

GS3 The Looming Crisis of World Unemployment

A World Bank forecast warns that 1.2 billion young people in the Global South will reach working age over the coming decade while the global economy will create only 400 million viable jobs. The resulting jobs gap of about 800 million threatens to turn the demographic dividend into social instability and forced migration towards the Global North. Traditional economic ladders like light manufacturing are stalling due to automation, robotics, and premature deindustrialisation in developing nations.

The Hindu

GS2 How Regulation Stifles HEIs

The Viksit Bharat Shiksha Adhishthan (VBSA) Bill, 2025, proposes a single overarching regulatory framework to replace separate higher education regulators. The Bill's stated aims are to ensure quality, enforce minimum standards, and prevent malpractice across colleges and universities. The core critique is that heavy external supervision creates a paper blizzard, forcing institutions to prioritize inspection files over actual teaching quality. Contradictory UGC regulations and metrics-driven ranking systems cause a trust deficit, stifling innovation and rewarding mere compliance.

The Hindu

GS2 Outbound force: On the U.S. leaving Iraq

The United States has ended its 23-year military involvement in Iraq with the final departure of forces on September 30, 2026. The U.S. first invaded Iraq in 2003 to remove Saddam Hussein and eliminate non-existent weapons of mass destruction, leading to prolonged conflict and sectarian violence. After withdrawing in 2011, U.S. forces returned in 2014 under Operation Inherent Resolve to combat the rise of Islamic State.

The Hindu

GS3 RBI MPC at a crossroads over its policy stance

The debate over policy stance has gained urgency due to excess liquidity created by FCNR inflows. The article discusses the policy choices facing the RBI Monetary Policy Committee as it weighs the effectiveness of rate hikes and CRR increases against excess liquidity. The key question is whether a 50-basis-points rate hike and 100bps CRR increase can rein in excess liquidity created by FCNR inflows.

Mint

GS3 Beyond GDP: The missing numbers

It appeared as an opinion piece in Deccan Herald addressing the shortcomings of traditional economic metrics. The article discusses the need to look beyond Gross Domestic Product and incorporate broader social and environmental indicators to measure national progress. Beyond GDP: The missing numbers

Deccan Herald

GS3 Best of Business Standard Opinion: Intention vs transmission in policy

It was featured in the Business Standard Opinion section, analyzing the challenges of policy execution in the real world. The editorial discusses how the success of economic and governance policies depends heavily on effective transmission rather than mere intention. These pieces show that intentions matter, but transmission decides what survives the journey from policy, price or principle to the real world

Business Standard

GS3 Despite G7, fuel inflation will remain

The G7's recent decision to release oil reserves amid political pressures prompted this editorial analysis. The editorial argues that the G7's release of 100 million barrels of oil will fail to curb fuel inflation because it overlaps with past commitments and faces severe structural supply issues. G7's recent decision to release 100 million barrels of oil from reserves is unlikely to significantly alleviate fuel inflation as it overlaps with earlier commitments.

Economic Times

GS3 BL Explainer: How does analogue paneer differ from conventional paneer? Why does FSSAI want to ban it?

The issue came to light as FSSAI raised concerns regarding enforcement difficulties due to the absence of specific quality parameters for dairy analogues. FSSAI highlighted that the lack of specific quality parameters for dairy analogues like analogue paneer makes enforcement difficult, leading to a proposed ban. The Food Safety and Standards Authority said the absence of specific quality parameters for dairy analogues, particularly in the case of paneer, makes enforcement difficult

BusinessLine

GS2 Two or three?: On the Court, students, three-language policy

The editorial was prompted by recent judicial observations regarding the three-language policy in schools. The Supreme Court observed that students should have the freedom to choose a third language without the pressure of Board examinations. Students must be free to choose a third language that is not tested in a Board exam

The Hindu

GS2 GS3 Industrial alcohol is the GST Council's unfinished federal business: States won the legal fight, but the 18% GST still applies

The issue is in the news because industrial alcohol continues to attract an 18% GST despite states winning a legal battle over their right to regulate it. The GST Council is scheduled to meet to address the taxation and regulation of industrial alcohol following a Supreme Court ruling that states have the power to regulate it. The GST Council is set to meet regarding the regulation of industrial alcohol, which has been contested between the government and states.

Economic Times

GS2 West Bengal, Tamil Nadu & Odisha: Policy shifts under new state governments will have much to reveal

The emergence of new state governments in these three states has brought policy revisions into focus. New state governments in West Bengal, Tamil Nadu and Odisha are introducing policy shifts that offer insights into regional governance. New governments in these three states mark a shift in direction, though less so in Tamil Nadu’s case than in the other two. We could regard these as natural experiments—and there will be much to learn from the impact of their policy revisions.

Mint

GS3 GST 2.0 and further reforms: The path to stronger state finances runs through a wider tax base

The piece appeared amid ongoing discussions regarding GST 2.0 reforms and the financial self-reliance of Indian states. The editorial discusses how Indian states can strengthen their finances by broadening their GST tax base. Roughly half of Indian states’ own tax revenue comes from the goods and services tax (GST). They have the capacity to increase this source of income. Here's how a small investment today could lead to a broader tax base tomorrow.

Mint

GS3 On the right path of easing ease of biz

To strengthen compliance and reduce conflicts, reforming the Goods and Services Tax (GST) administration is essential. The GST Council will introduce initiatives to rectify persistent tax structure issues. India's energy sector remains excluded from GST, affecting economic progress and inflation rates. It's also vital to recognize states' contribution to tax revenue to preserve fiscal independence. Additionally, a portion of GST revenue could support urban municipal bodies in fostering sustainable development.

Economic Times

GS3 Power to arrest under GST

The Indian government is considering removing the power of tax authorities to arrest taxpayers under the Goods and Services Tax law. This proposal follows months of consultations between the Centre and states driven by business concerns over alleged tax overreach. The proposal is scheduled for discussion at the 57th GST Council meeting on Wednesday, 7 October. If approved, statutory amendments would be introduced during the upcoming Winter Session of Parliament.

BusinessLine

GS2 Next UNSG's top task, UNmaking irrelevance

The impending end of Antonio Guterres' term in three months has put the selection process and the future challenges of the next UN chief in the news. The editorial discusses the impending transition of leadership at the United Nations as Secretary General Antonio Guterres prepares to leave office amidst deep global divisions. With just three months left in his term, Secretary General Antonio Guterres prepares to pass the torch to his successor.

Economic Times

GS3 The business case for climate action

Climate change and nature loss have transformed from distant threats into immediate board-level business risks driven by extreme weather, geopolitical strains, and volatile energy prices. The author argues for reversing business priorities to act on climate immediately, driven by economic value, operational resilience, and market realities rather than mere charity. Three key motivators stand out: ethical responsibility due to accelerating warming, reputational demands from customers and employees, and the smart economic sense of resource efficiency.

Economic Times

EXPLAINED

The concept behind the news, one or two lines each.

India's Higher Education: Regulation and Reform The Viksit Bharat Shiksha Adhishthan (VBSA) Bill, 2025 proposes to replace the UGC, AICTE and NCTE with a single apex regulatory body. The Bill was introduced in the Lok Sabha on 15 December 2025 and referred to a 31-member Joint Parliamentary Committee (JPC) for review.

ForumIAS

Flock cameras and the Fourth Amendment: What did the federal judge rule on police searches? Privacy concerns explained A federal judge in Oklahoma ruled that a Tulsa County sheriff's deputy violated the Fourth Amendment during a vehicle search. The deputy searched a vehicle's historical location data using Flock and another license-plate reader system without a warrant.

Hindustan Times

Why NHRC issued a notice on CJP's Mumbai protesters The NHRC sent notices to the Mumbai Police chief, MeitY, and other authorities following a complaint alleging the mobilisation and involvement of minors in a public protest. The complaint was filed by Satish Vaid, citing posts on X and alleging the abuse of children for the protest held in Mumbai.

The Hindu

CJI says Supreme Court did not approve Form 6 changes: What the form is, why it matters The opposition INDIA bloc held a protest march named Save Democracy towards the Election Commission in New Delhi. Opposition leaders accused the Election Commission of irregularities and demanded the resignation of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar. The protest was triggered by controversies surrounding voter roll revisions and modifications made to Form 6.

news.webindia123.com

Legislative privilege versus free speech: What was the Supreme Court reference about? The Supreme Court indicated it may defer examining the constitutional questions on legislative privilege and free speech because the Tamil Nadu Assembly resolution that triggered the case was withdrawn in 2004.

The Hindu

Rabies and the missing deaths: Why do India's official numbers differ so sharply from estimates? The release of findings from an ICMR-led study regarding animal bites and anti-rabies vaccination gaps. An ICMR-led study highlights significant gaps in post-exposure vaccination compliance among animal bite victims in India, shedding light on why official rabies mortality figures differ sharply from estimates.

The Hindu

Nobel Medicine Prize 2026: How three scientists discovered a way to control brain cells with light Karl Deisseroth, Peter Hegemann, and Georg Nagel won the 2026 Nobel Prize in Medicine for research on light-activated ion channels and optogenetics. Peter Hegemann discovered the light-sensitive protein channelrhodopsin on the surface of single-cell algae called Chlamydomonas.

newsx.com

SC seeks EC response on changes during SIR: Why has Form 6 become a flashpoint The Supreme Court questioned changes made to Form 6 during the Election Commission's Special Intensive Revision of electoral rolls. Petitions alleged decisions were taken without approval of all election commissioners, creating a rift between CEC Gyanesh Kumar and other members.

Times of India

Why edible oils are bearing the brunt of food inflation Recent surges in consumer price index data put a renewed focus on edible oil inflation. This explainer analyzes the primary economic and global factors causing edible oils to drive high food inflation rates.
Indian Express

Can Supreme Court Suspend Gyanesh Kumar? The Constitutional Question Behind The Unprecedented Plea The filing of an extraordinary legal plea questioning the suspension powers of the Supreme Court put the matter in the news. An unprecedented plea has raised the constitutional question of whether the Supreme Court can suspend Gyanesh Kumar.
News18

Medicine Nobel goes to scientists who can 'control brain using light': What exactly their work is The 2026 Nobel Prize in Physiology or Medicine was awarded to Karl Deisseroth, Peter Hegemann, and Georg Nagel for controlling nerve cells using light. Their work laid the foundation for optogenetics, a technique enabling scientists to switch individual nerve cells on or off with light pulses.
cnbctv18.com

Mint explainer: how Brics' new tax platforms could change cross-border taxation The announcement of BRICS creating new international tax platforms puts the spotlight on emerging economies reshaping cross-border taxation. BRICS is establishing new platforms on international taxation, transfer pricing, and revenue data to influence global tax rules. The move could give emerging economies a stronger voice in shaping cross-border tax rules.
Mint

ALSO IN THE NEWS

Reactions, previews and smaller stories: one line each.

- India, US have reached a plateau in trade talks, says FM Nirmala Sitharaman (International Relations) Economic Times
- Ramappa Temple: History, Architecture & UNESCO World Heritage Site (History, Art & Culture) INSIGHTS IAS
- UPI MDR should not attract any GST: Former RBI Governor C Rangarajan (Economy) BusinessLine
- India to set up three major chemical parks under Bhavya Rasayan scheme (Economy) BusinessLine
- Union Minister Shri Pralhad Joshi to Inaugurate Windergy India 2026 in Chennai (Infrastructure & Energy) PIB
- UN 'pre-COP' climate summit kicks off in Fiji (Environment & Ecology) The Hindu
- EAM Dr S Jaishankar addresses 62nd Munich Security Conference in New Delhi (International Relations) All India Radio (NewsOnAir)
- Coal India Signs MoU with HURL for Coal Gasification Project (Infrastructure & Energy) Construction World
- Gecko alert: Two new species discovered | Tap to know more (Environment & Ecology) Inshorts
- First-of-its-Kind Pilot Project under MCAD-SAMRIDHI Scheme launched at Patyari Cluster Samba; agreement signed for Development of Pressurized Pipe Irrigation Network with SCADA/IoT-Based Irrigation Services (Governance & Policy) JK MONITOR
- GST Council meeting postponed for second time, rescheduled to October 8 (Economy) Mint
- Dnipro River (Geography) ForumIAS
- 'Who modified Form 6?': SC seeks record from EC over voter form changes (Polity & Constitution) Hindustan Times
- Can CEC Gyanesh Kumar exercise EC powers alone? SC to hear plea today (Polity & Constitution) Times of India
- Climate Change Is Becoming a Pregnancy Hazard Worldwide, Survey Finds (Health) ipsnews.net
- GST Council may scrap arrest provisions, fast-track refunds with 90% automatic payout (Economy) Economic Times
- GST Council may widen ITC on business vehicles, ease interstate checks (Economy) Business Standard
- Uttar Pradesh receives investment proposals worth over Rs. 600 crore related to fisheries sector (Agriculture & Allied) The Hindu
- Akash air defence system reaches Turkmenistan: Check its capabilities as it joins Chinese systems to protect the Central Asian country (Defence) Economic Times
- Capital punishment only possible if reformation of convict is ruled out: Supreme Court (Polity & Constitution) Hindustan Times
- No material to conclude that Delhi Police compromised 2020 Delhi riots probe: Delhi High Court (Internal Security) Bar & Bench
- IIT Delhi demonstrates quantum entanglement alongside classical data over optical fibre (Science & Technology) ThePrint
- Endangered Great Indian Bustard Takes Fresh Flight, But Experts Sound Alarm (Environment & Ecology) NDTV
- Govt pushes rare-earth magnet capacity, India seeks control over critical manufacturing inputs: Shaktikanta Das (Economy) BusinessLine
- Most of rural agricultural workers landed in non-productive, informal urban jobs in 25 years: study (Economy) The Hindu
- GST enforcement may shift from 'arrest' to 'detect, recover and prosecute serious frauds' (Economy) Economic Times
- Kesavananda Bharati Case and Doctrine of Basic Structure of Constitution of India (Polity & Constitution) Shiksha.com
- Private investment picking up in India as capital formation grows at fastest pace in over three years (Economy) BusinessLine
- India, US plan strategic projects in Indian Ocean (International Relations) Hindustan Times
- S.19 JJ Act | Children's Court Must Assess Need For Trial Of Juvenile As Adult Notwithstanding Juvenile... (Polity & Constitution) LiveLaw
- We Did Not Approve Revised Form 6, Says CJI Surya Kant, Contradicting ECIs Claim (Polity & Constitution) The Wire
- India To Get $100 Billion Swiss Investment, 10 Lakh Jobs In 15 Years: PM Modi (Economy) Free Press Journal
- 'Can Put On Hold': Top Court To Examine Poll Body Decisions Amid Dissent Row (Polity & Constitution) NDTV
- Key Takeaways From Supreme Court's Observations On Top Poll Officer Row (Polity & Constitution) NDTV

- U.S.-Israeli strikes on Iran enter 11th day as UAE intercepts missiles and drones (International Relations) DD News
- Jitendra Singh congratulates ISRO for successful completion of IADT-02 for Gaganyaan Mission (Science & Technology) DD News
- Critically discuss why India struggles to move past the “screwdriver assembly” model to core component manufacturing like PCB assembly. What measures are needed? (Economy) GKToday
- Underlined the legal distinction between sovereignty in the territorial sea and sovereign rights in the EEZ under UNCLOS. How does this affect maritime law enforcement? (International Relations) GKToday
- Modi, Swiss President sign 5 MoUs, bet big on innovation, infra, people-to-people ties (International Relations) The Federal
- EPF Wage Ceiling Raised to INR 25,000: Mandatory Coverage & Payroll Changes in India (Economy) India Briefing
- CAFE III Rules Push India Toward Cleaner Passenger Vehicles (Environment & Ecology) usthadian.com
- RBI Rate Hike Expected This Week: 60% of Economists See 25bps Increase (Economy) IndexBox
- RBI MPC Meeting Oct 2026: Dates, outcome announcement time, when & where to watch LIVE speech of Guv Sanjay Malhotra (Economy) Livemint

COVERAGE CHECK

Items — 21 must-know, 19 Prelims facts, 43 in the news, 19 editorials, 12 explainers.

Syllabus areas in the cards — Polity & Constitution (10), International Relations (7), Environment & Ecology (6), Economy (4), Governance & Policy (3), Defence (3), Science & Technology (2), Infrastructure & Energy (2), Social Justice & Welfare (1), Education (1), History, Art & Culture (1). **Nothing today in —** Health, Agriculture & Allied, Internal Security, Disaster Management, Geography, Society, Ethics & Integrity.

Easy-miss watch — Marine & coastal (EEZ, UNCLOS, Blue Economy, deep sea): 3 · Digital Public Infrastructure & data governance: 2 · Political change in the neighbourhood: nothing today · Appointments to constitutional / statutory / regulatory bodies: 1 · Defence-technology cooperation agreements: nothing today

Full text — 47 of 71 items were read in full from a free copy; the rest are summarised from the outlets' reports. Subscriber-only sites are never opened.

Sources in the cards — The Hindu 13, PIB 7, Economic Times 6, BusinessLine 5, Hindustan Times 4, newsonair.gov.in 4, Mint 4, ddnews.gov.in 3, Business Standard 2, Times of India 2, Deccan Herald 2, Solarbytes 1, TaxCorp AI 1, Bar & Bench 1

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